

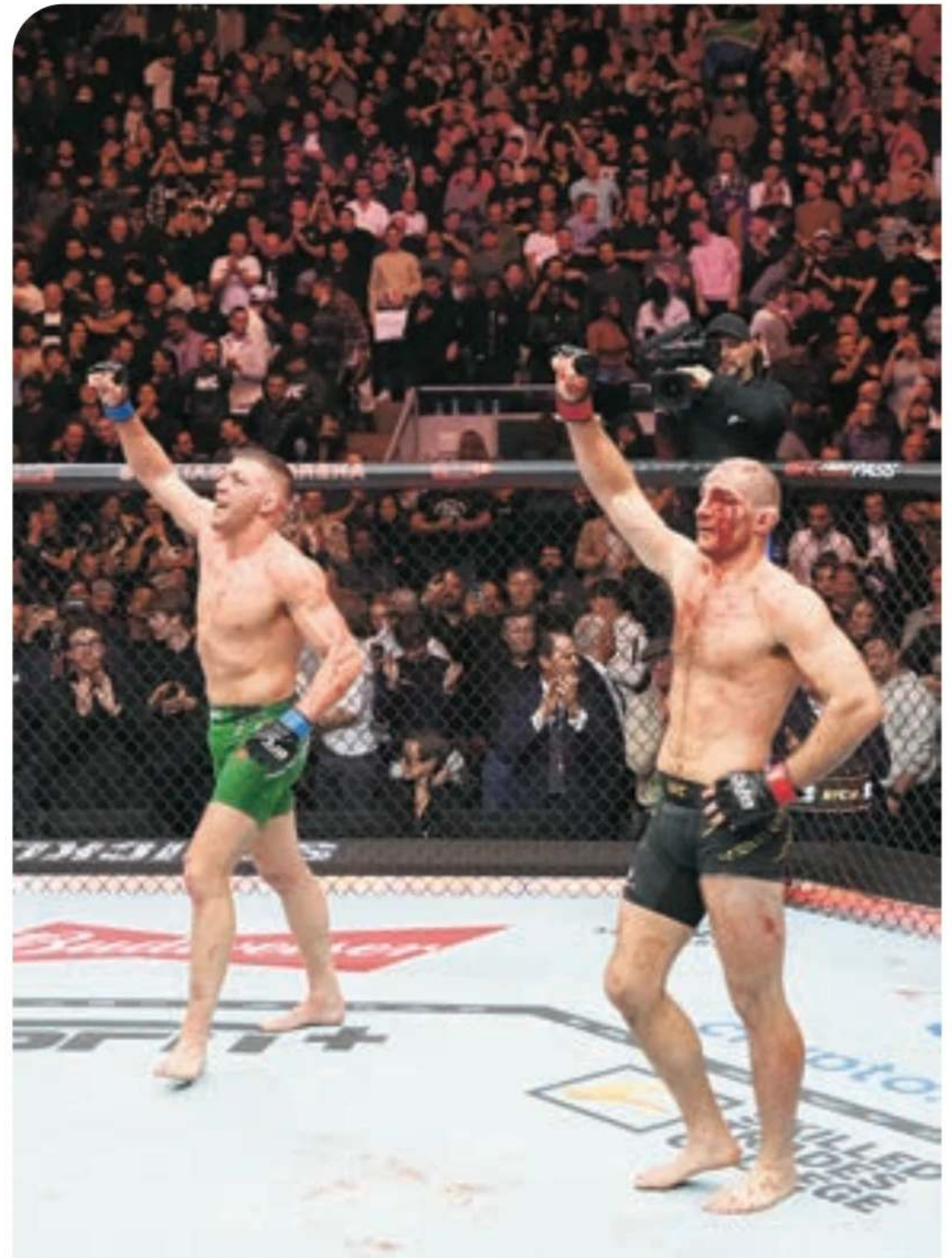
UFC 312 Du Plessis vs Strickland

The first weekend of February will feature another rematch when middleweight champion 'Stillknocks' Dricus du Plessis takes on former champ Sean Strickland.

Du Plessis became the division's champion after just six fights, outlasting Strickland to clinch the title. Stillknocks started on the back foot as Strickland found his rhythm with superior range and relentless jabs.

But as the rounds progressed, du Plessis found his footing, mixing heavy jabs with occasional takedowns. Eventually, the judges were tasked with determining the final verdict, and when their scorecards were tabulated, du Plessis became the first athlete from South Africa to claim UFC gold.

Du Plessis will look to replicate his success in February and become one of the few fighters to defend the belt multiple times, while Strickland will be out for revenge to reclaim what he lost.



UFC Fight Night Puja vs Bannon

After her successful foray into the UFC, India's Puja Tomar will travel to London to face fellow newcomer Shauna Bannon of Ireland.

Puja became the first Indian to win a bout in the UFC when she secured a split decision victory over Brazil's Rayanne dos Santos in June last year. She has built a five-fight win streak, including a title defence in the Matrix Fight Night promotion.

Bannon, on the other hand, is 1-1 in her UFC journey so far. The Irishwoman was unbeaten in her career before joining the UFC, with stints in Cage Legacy and Invicta FC.

She suffered her first loss in her UFC debut against Bruna Brasil in July 2023. However, she bounced back at UFC 304 after a year's gap, defeating Alice Ardelean for her first UFC win.

